

# **SELINA MARTIN** Curriculum Vitae

## Summary / En bref / Resumen

I'm an innovative songwriter and music-maker originally from a farm in the Ottawa Valley, Canada. I moved to Toronto to go to university and to find my cultural community. I moved from Toronto to France, and I'm presently in Spain. I do not adhere to specific genres of music, instead I strive to evolve as an artist and performer, incorporating new influences with each successive project.

I've released five highly critically acclaimed solo recordings and collaborated and toured with many luminaries from the Canadian independent music scene including Rheostatics, Martin Tielli and Dave Bidini (both Rheostatics), Mary Margaret O'Hara, Bob Wiseman (formerly Blue Rodeo), John Wright and Tom Holliston (both formerly NoMeansNo), and am presently collaborating with an instrumental Spanish duo (Muno Na Baka).

## **Post-secondary Education**

Honours B.A., Drama Program, University of Toronto, 1986 - 1991

## **Music Education**

Primarily a self-taught composer, musician, arranger and lyricist with several exceptions listed below:

- Recording software/studio engineering tutorials - Michael Phillip Wojewoda 2009, 2014.
- "Resampled Workshop" - weekend intensive electronic music production workshop 2012.
- Keyboards and analog studio techniques tutorials - Bob Wiseman 1999.
- musical saw - Gene Hardy
- vocal training - Stella Walker
- guitar finger picking - Nick Yaksich
- private piano instruction - Susan Gallagher

## **Instruments**

Guitar (acoustic & electric), voice, bass guitar, piano, accordion, synthesizers, Theremin, musical saw, vibraphone, various percussion, tuned wine glasses, ukulele, found objects.

## Awards

Canada Council for the Arts – Arts Across Canada 2024

Canada Council for the Arts – Explore and Create, Concept to Realization 2021

FACTOR – Demo Award 2000. Songwriter Workshop Grant 2012. Artist Development 2021

Toronto Arts Council – Album Recording Grant, 2013

Ontario Arts Council – Album Recording Grant, 2009

## Teaching History

- 2024 – Songwriting Boot Camp, Penticton – instructor
- 2016 – Adult Songwriting Course, University of Toronto – instructor
- 2014/15 – University of Toronto Adult songwriting course/ George Brown College songwriting course – guest lecturer

## Selected Music History

- 2022-2026 – recording collaborations with Muno Na Baka (Valencia, ES), Torrance, and Dead Bob.
- 2022 – release of 5<sup>th</sup> independent solo recording, *Time Spent Swimming*.
- 2015 – release of 4<sup>th</sup> independent solo recording, *i've been picking caruso's brain; i think i have the information we need to make a new world*.
- 2012, 2011, and 2010 *Torn From The Pages* (Globe & Mail Authors' Festival) – Commissioned to compose and perform songs inspired by/derived from Canadian novels.
- 2011 – composing/recording project with experimental electronic collective FFoB to compose a series of new works combining conventional songwriting with improvisational electronic modes of creation. FFoB (The Faceless Forces of Bigness) are Juno Award-winning producer Michael Phillip Wojewoda, renowned guitarist and electronic composer Kurt Swinghammer, NOW's "Producer of the Year" Chris Stringer, and moving image designer Justin Stephenson).
- 2010 – release of 3<sup>rd</sup> independent solo recording, *Disaster Fantasies*.
- 2009 – co-composer of film score with Dave Bidini, Martin Tielli (Rheostatics), & Fred Frith for *Act Of God* – a documentary film by Jennifer Baichwall (*Manufactured Landscapes*).
- 2009 – co-producer of double album *The Ghost of Danny Gross*, by Martin Tielli.
- 2008 – 2009 – touring and recording multi-instrumentalist (guitars, musical saw, percussive sticks, voice, chains, other found sounds) with Martin Tielli.
- 2006 – arranger and performer on musical saw and wine glasses of songs by Claude Debussy for "The Laments"; a classical quintet with Jordan O'Connor (upright bass), Julia Hambleton (clarinet), Annelise Noronha (accordion) and Donna Linklater (soprano voice).
- 2005 – release of 2<sup>nd</sup> full-length studio album *Life Drawing Without Instruction*.
- 2003 – improviser on tuned wine glasses with experimental electronic band The Faceless Forces of Bigness (FFoB).
- 1998 – release of 1<sup>st</sup> full-length album *Space Woman*.

- 1995 – 1999 – multi-instrumentalist with Bob Wiseman (formerly Blue Rodeo) on tour and recordings (theremin, accordion, guitars, keyboards, tuned wine glasses, voice).

## Discography

- Selina Martin, *Time Spent Swimming* (Outside Music Distribution 2022)
- Selina Martin, *i've been picking caruso's brain; i think i have the information we need to make a new world* (Outside Music Distribution, 2015)
- Compilation – *Have Not Been the Same* (Zunior, 2011)
- Selina Martin, *Disaster Fantasies* (Outside Music Distribution, 2010)
- The Five Hole Band, *Music from "Five Hole: Tales of Hockey Erotica"* (Zunior, 2009)
- Selina Martin, *Life Drawing Without Instruction* (Outside Music Distribution, 2005)
- Selina Martin, *Space Woman* (Festival Distribution, 1998)

## Selected Accompaniment/Production Discography

- Amelia Curran (Spectators) (Six Shooter Records, 2013)
- Bidiniband, *In The Rock Hall* (Pheromone Recordings, 2011)
- Martin Tielli, *The Ghost of Danny Gross, Parts 1 and 2*. (co-produced by Selina Martin and Martin Tielli) (Six Shooter Records, 2009)
- Justin Rutledge, *The Devil on a Bench in Stanley Park* (Six Shooter Records, 2006)
- Veda Hille, *Return of the Killdeer* (Ape Records (UK), 2005)
- N.Q. Arbuckle, *The Last Supper in a Cheap Town* (Six Shooter Records, 2005)
- Rheostatics, *2067* (True North Records, 2004)
- Martin Tielli, *Operation Infinite Joy* (Six Shooter Records, 2003)
- Martin Tielli, *We didn't even suspect that he was the poppy salesman* (Six Shooter, 2000)
- Bob Wiseman, *More Work Songs from the Planet of the Apes* (Grow or Die Music, 1999)

## Composer and performer for theatre (selections)

- *A Blow in the Face* – Lisa Ryder / Bald Ego Theatre (composer/performer)
- *Do You Want What I Have Got? A Craigslist Cantata* – Veda Hille/Bill Richardson
- *Five Hole; Tales of Hockey Erotica* – One Yellow Rabbit (composer/performer)
- *Hedwig and the Angry Inch, Dali, Godzilla* – Crows Theatre (composer/performer)
- *Three Penny Epic Cabaret, Sleepers Awake, City / Slouch Hat, Panting of the Victors, Orpheus, And He Lost His Head, Café Naked* – Bald Ego Theatre (composer/performer)

## Composer and performer for film & TV

- *One Week*, Mulmer's One Week Inc., Michael McGowan
- *Act of God*, Mercury Films, Jennifer Baichwall & Nick dePencier
- *Five Hole*, the animated short film, Anlanda, Cam Christiansen
- *Twitch City*, CBC TV/Accent Ent., Bruce McDonald
- *S.F. Seeks*, El Ryder Productions/Wish Productions
- *Once a Thief*, John Woo
- *Twisted Sheets*, Chris Deacon
- *The Best Years*, Best Years 2 Productions Inc.

## Selected Music Tours

- Outsider-Inside solo tour EU May 2026
- Canada duo tour March April 2024
- Germany, Italy duo tour May 2023
- Canada duo tour March April 2023
- Europe trio tour July 2022
- France trio tour fall 2022
- UK and Europe solo + band tour, Oct - Dec 2019
- Western Canada solo tour, July-Aug 2019
- Poland tour Selina Martin band, June 2019
- Ontario tour Selina Martin band, March 2019
- Europe solo tour with Tom Holliston, Oct - Dec 2018
- Western Canada solo tour and Toronto band show - June 2018
- Europe solo tour, March 2018
- Western Canada solo tour, Dec 2017
- France solo tour, Oct - Nov 2017
- Ontario tour Selina Martin band, Oct - Nov 2016
- Canada Album launch tour Selina Martin band , March 2016
- Europe Album launch tour, Nov 2015
- Alberta & British Columbia solo tour, 2014
- Quebec/Maritimes - Selina Martin Triplets tour, 2011
- Ontario/Quebec - *Disaster Fantasies* album launch tour, 2010
- Ontario/Quebec - Martin Tielli tour, 2008
- Italy - Selina Martin solo tour, 2007 & 2008
- Bluebird North National Tour, 2007
- Eastern Canada - Selina Martin band, 2006 & 2005
- Western Canada - Selina Martin band, 2006 & 1999
- Canada, US & Europe - Bob Wiseman band with Selina Martin 1995-1999

## Selected Music Festival Appearances

- 2026 - Karman Festival - Augsburg DE
- 2024 - Ignite the Arts - Penticton BC
- 2023 - Ignite the Arts - Penticton BC, Karman Festival - Augsburg DE,  
Fête de la musique - Biot FR, Fête Saint-Julien - Biot FR
- 2022 - Boskovice Festival CZ
- 2019 - ArtsWells, Wells BC. Islands Fest - Duncan BC.
- 2017 - ArtsWells, Wells BC.
- 2013 - Interstellar Rodeo, Edmonton
- 2012 - Hillside Festival, Guelph, ArtsWells Festival, BC, Waterfront Festival, Toronto
- 2011 - Halifax Urban Folk Festival, Raise the Roof Women's Music Festival,
- 2006 - Evolve Festival, Antigonish
- 2005 - Tim Posgate's Festival of Autumnal Happiness, Toronto Island
- 2002 - Dog Day Afternoon, Guelph
- 2001 - Ottawa Folk Festival
- 2000 - Hillside Festival, New York Underground Poetry and Music Festival,
- 1999 - Edmonton Folk Festival
- 1998 - New Music West, Calgary Folk Festival, North by North East
- 1997 - Vancouver Folk Festival

## Selected Press

"This is a master work by an artist at the peak of her potential" - Roots Music Canada

"Musically and lyrically this album offers so much.. *Time Spent Swimming* is fascinating. It is hard to categorize, and this is a compliment." - Spill Magazine, CAN

"sounds like a never-released collaboration between Peter Gabriel and Bjork" - Fidelity, DE

"convention-defying fusion of pop and art rock" - France 24

"*Time Spent Swimming* shoots into the stratosphere" - Exclaim!, CAN

"*Time Spent Swimming* goes deep, and I'm falling more and more in love with it after every listen." - Airplane on the Highway, CAN

"Thrilling" - Actua News, FR

"five-stars ... I found time between gigs to write this review because the record is so good" - West End Phoenix, CAN

"Martin knows how to impress." - Les Oreilles Curieuses, FR

"... bubbling over with ideas, walking right between such 'sound world travelers' as LAURIE ANDERSON, ANNE CLARK and BRIAN ENO, but also flirting with a KATE BUSH or AMANDA PALMER and BJÖRK as well as the TALKING HEADS." - Musikreviews.de

Album of the Year - NBT Music Radio, Köln, Germany

"...brilliant... We can't recommend this album to you enough. Superb in every sense of the word" - Starship Overflow Radio, UK

"... genius ... Reference artists could be Talking Heads and PJ Harvey, but probably this lady is better called 'unique'" - Rootstime, BE

"new, exciting, provocative, uninhibited, sometimes ferocious, sometimes tranquil, never boring" - Zero Magazine, SWE

"a very remarkable piece of work" - Written in Music, The Netherlands

"profound, original, and beautiful" - Keys & Chords, Belgium

NNNN "Martin pulls off something Kate Bushingly theatrical and epic" - NOW Toronto

\*\*\*\*\* 5/5 Stars - the Music Express, CAN

"Selina Martin - aural visionary" - 100.3 SoundFM, CAN

"a masterful work that showcases Martin's magical talent for writing simultaneously from the heart, brain and gut." - Exclaim!, CAN

"One of the 10 best albums of the year" (Disaster Fantasies) - Ottawa Citizen, CAN

"Disaster Fantasies is one of the Globe's picks for the Polaris Prize" - Globe & Mail, CAN

\*\*\*\* 4/4 stars - "Selina Martin has the voice of a thrift shop angel and the eye of an eagle circling over its prey" - Globe & Mail

"*Throw Me In The Water*, *Breathe In*, and *Always On My Mind* all candidates for the song of the year." - Michael Barclay (Macleans, Radio Free Canuckistan)

CBC Radio 3 Track of the Day - "Public Safety Management" / "One of the most intriguing songwriters in Toronto" - Vish Khanna

\*\*\*\* "*Life Drawing Without Instruction* is a compelling collection, showcasing Martin's musicianship, vocal talent, and songwriting." - Vue Magazine

"Martin revels in the unexpected on her tough, tender, and frequently astounding sophomore effort" - Ottawa Xpress

Globe & Mail ESSENTIAL TRACKS: *The Hottest Day* and *The Spirit of Radio* (from *Disaster Fantasies*)